

fact, “returning to the nest” is starting to become as commonplace as “leaving the nest.” Unfortunately, the excitement that accompanies the first time a young adult moves away from home is seldom repeated when they find they must now move back.

This chapter will profile the various situations that led young adults to move back home. Reasons such as:

- Not following a budget
- Not prioritizing “needs” before “wants”
- Not doing cost of living research
- Not being able to afford the big city
- Not expecting and preparing for “life events”

Three Strikes and You’re Out

Before you move out on your own, it is essential to draw up a budget. After doing so, you must calculate moving expenses. The resulting bottom line figures will affect all your decisions. It will determine where you move, whom you live with, the furnishings you obtain, and even the type of cable service you choose. Knowing how much money is available in comparison to your expenses is crucial information if you want to make wise financial decisions. Not choosing to know this information will only guarantee decisions made in the dark. These choices will not be based in reality and will often not be sustainable. When Christopher decided to move out, he discovered the price he had to pay for not doing his homework.

Christopher was eighteen years old when he moved away from home for the first time. The going away party for Christopher was quite an event. All of his relatives came to celebrate his transition to manhood. His departure was accompanied by a lot of fanfare as he finally drove away in his pickup, which was overflowing with all of his belongings.

